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(54) **DATA SHARING APPARATUS AND METHOD OF MOBILE TERMINAL**

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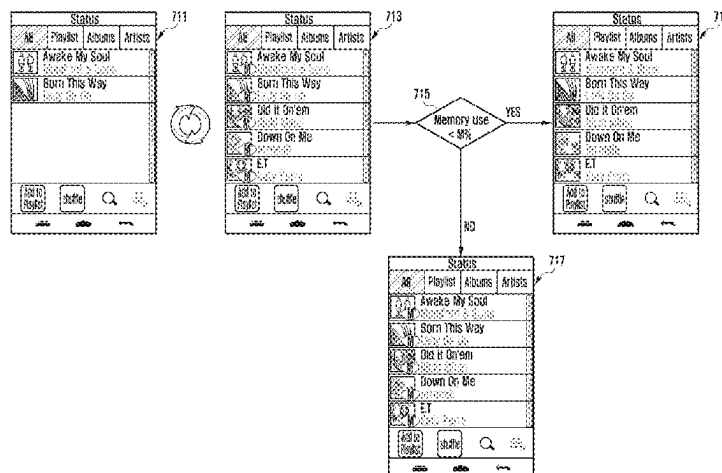
Primary Examiner — Jungwon Chang

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

An apparatus and method for sharing data between a cloud server and at least one terminal are provided. The method includes displaying, when a data type is selected on a setting menu screen of a cloud service, meta information of real data corresponding to the selected data type, the meta information being downloaded from a server, downloading, when a piece of meta information is selected, the real data corresponding to the selected piece of meta information from the server, and deleting, when the downloaded real data is consumed completely, the consumed real data.

22 Claims, 17 Drawing Sheets



Related U.S. Application Data

continuation of application No. 16/263,854, filed on Jan. 31, 2019, now Pat. No. 11,082,477, which is a continuation of application No. 15/435,594, filed on Feb. 17, 2017, now Pat. No. 10,200,450, which is a continuation of application No. 13/765,021, filed on Feb. 12, 2013, now Pat. No. 9,584,623.

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H04L 67/1095 (2022.01)
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H04L 67/5682 (2022.01)
H04L 67/5683 (2022.01)
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(52) U.S. Cl.

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FIG. 1

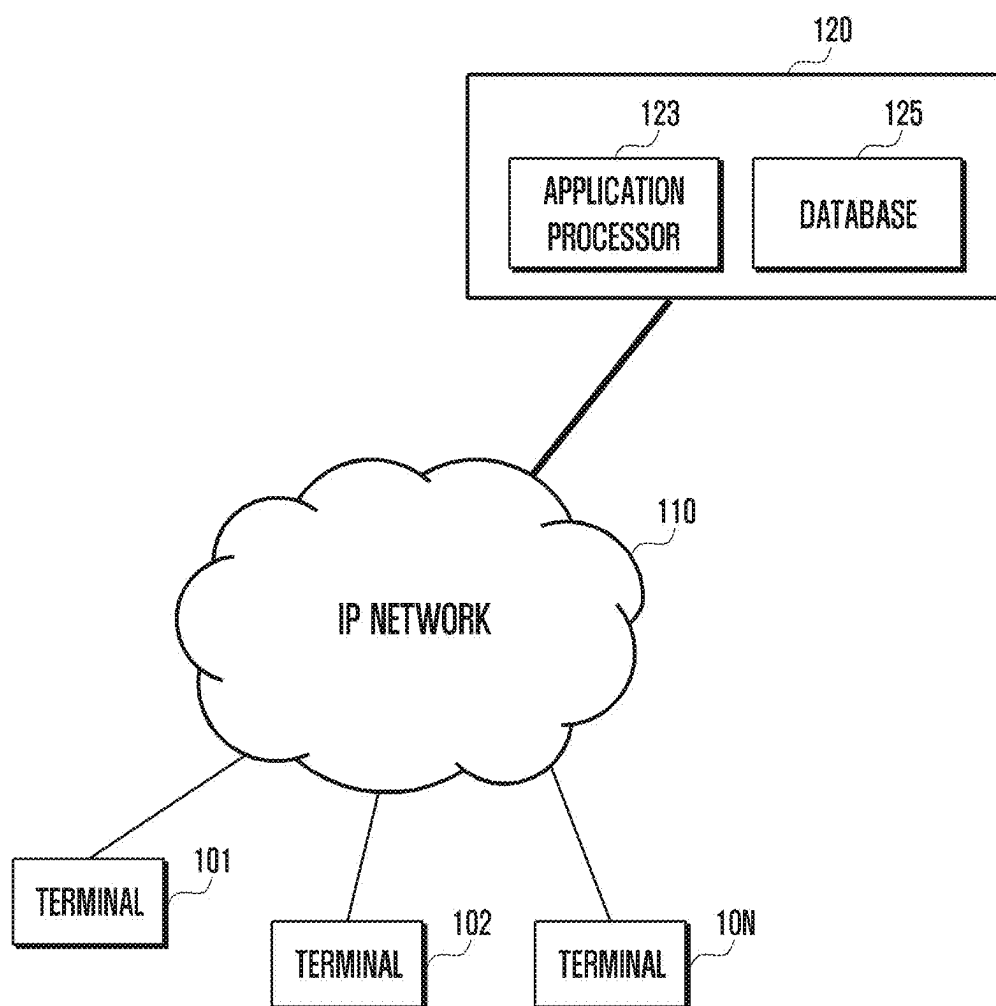


FIG. 2

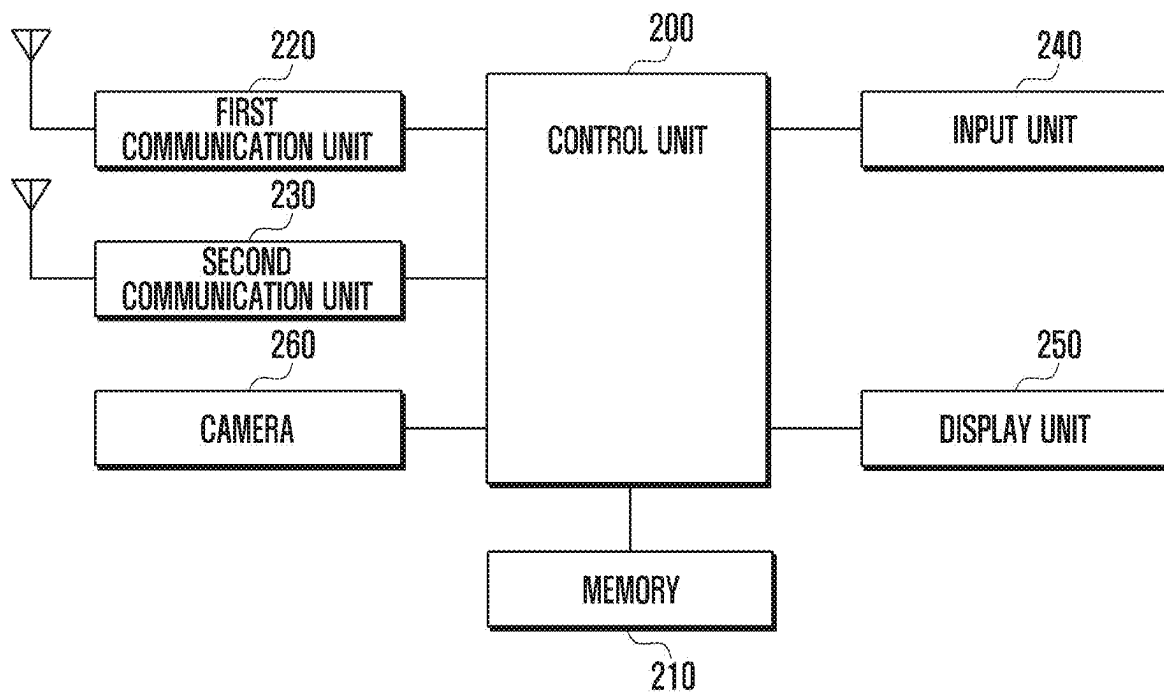


FIG. 3A

WIRELESS AND NETWORK
VOICE
AUDIO
VIDEO
⋮
Cloud
⋮

FIG. 3B

Meta only	on/off
MUSIC	on/off
VIDEO	on/off
PICTURE	on/off
DOCUMENT	on/off
⋮	

FIG. 4A

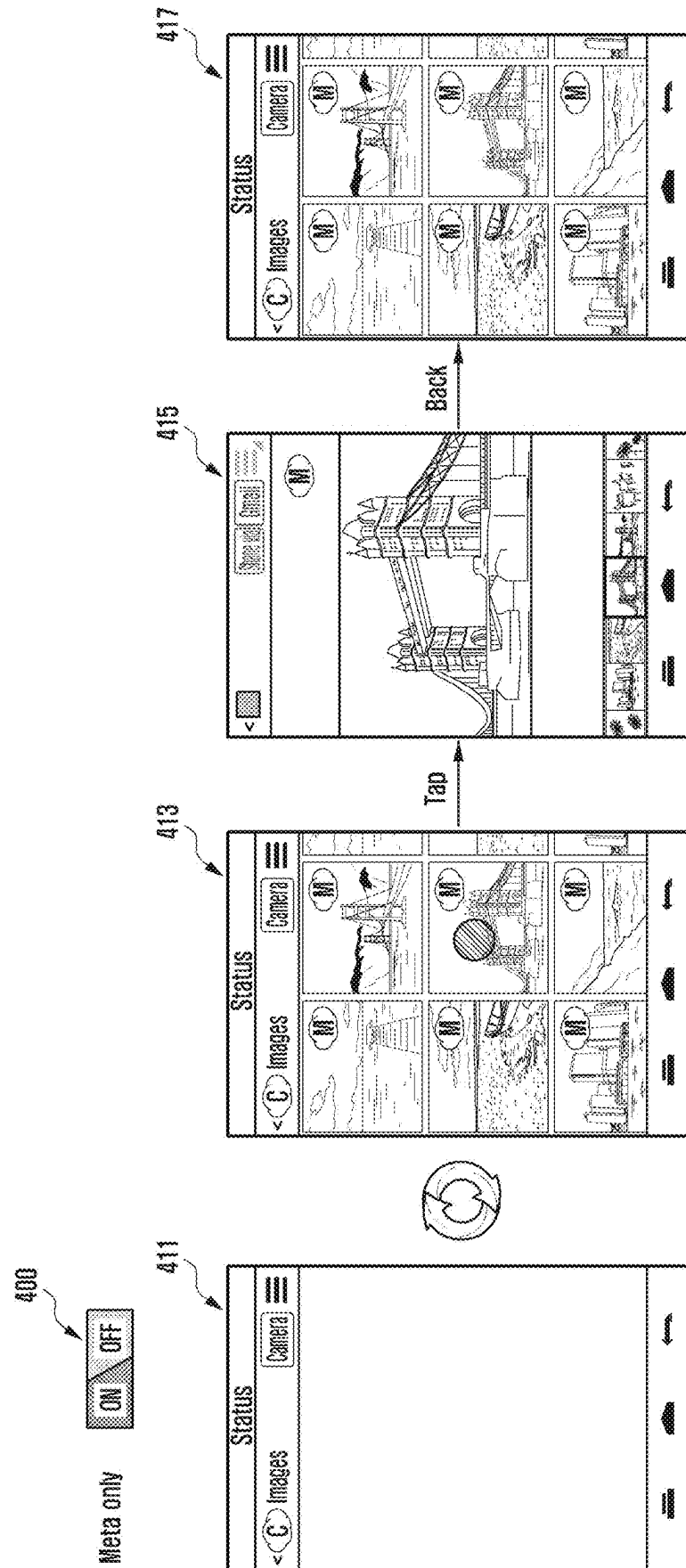


FIG. 4B

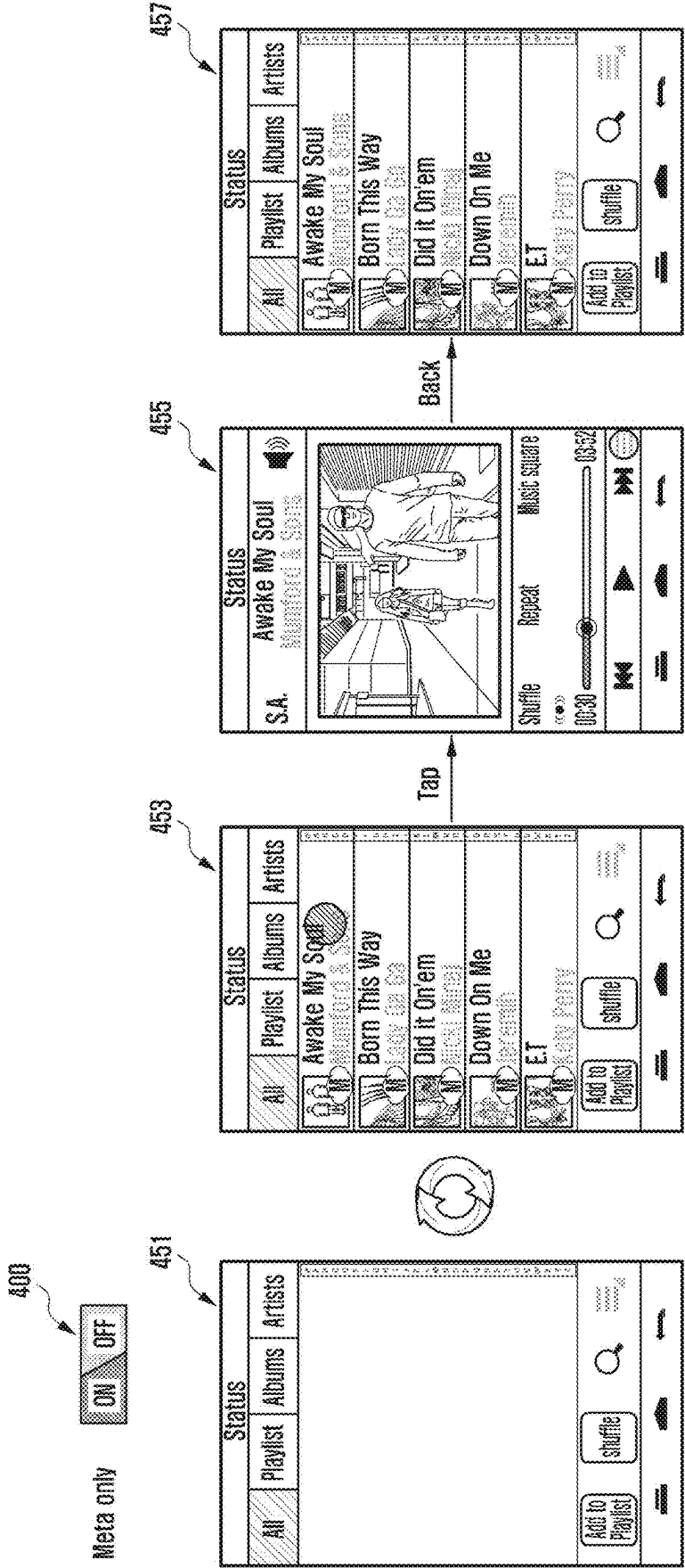


FIG. 5A

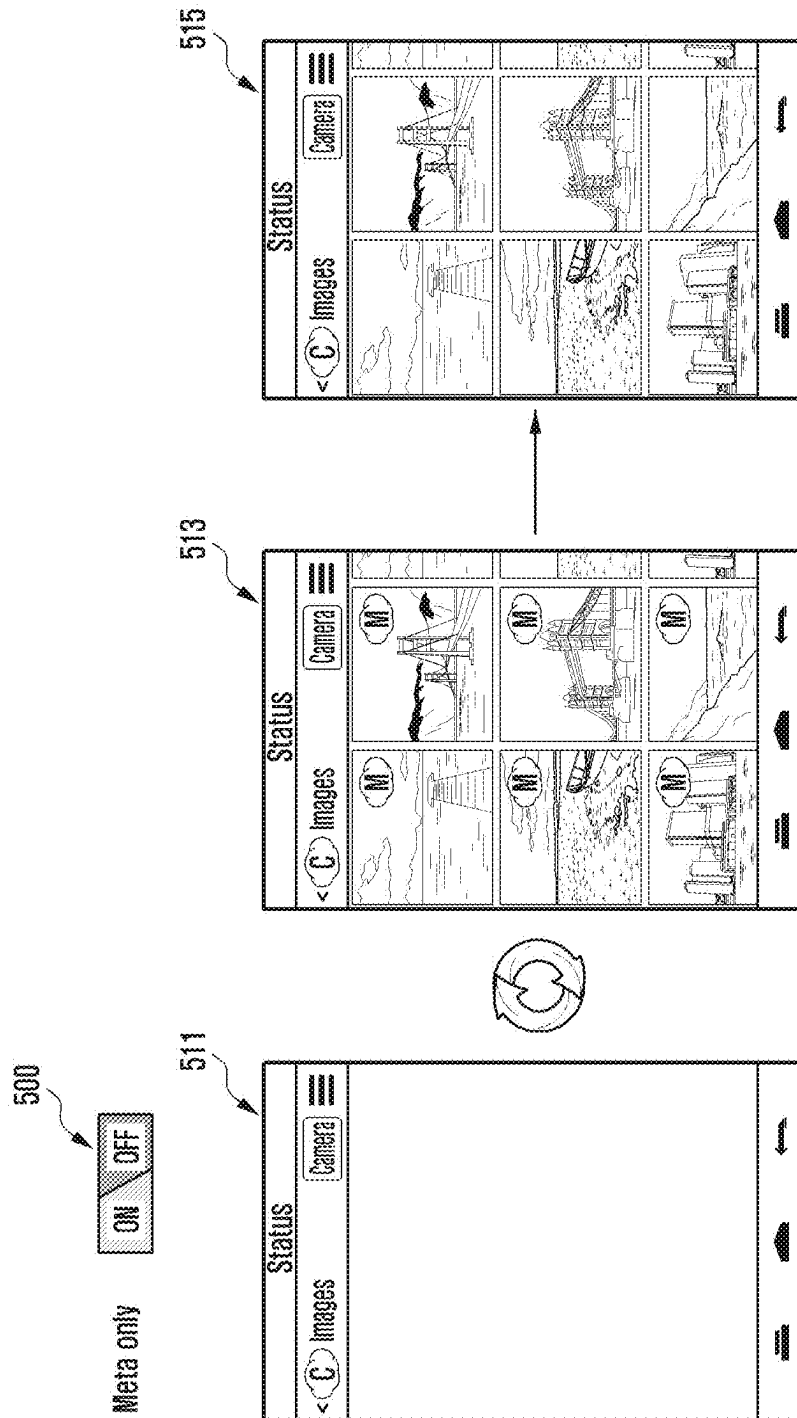


FIG. 5B

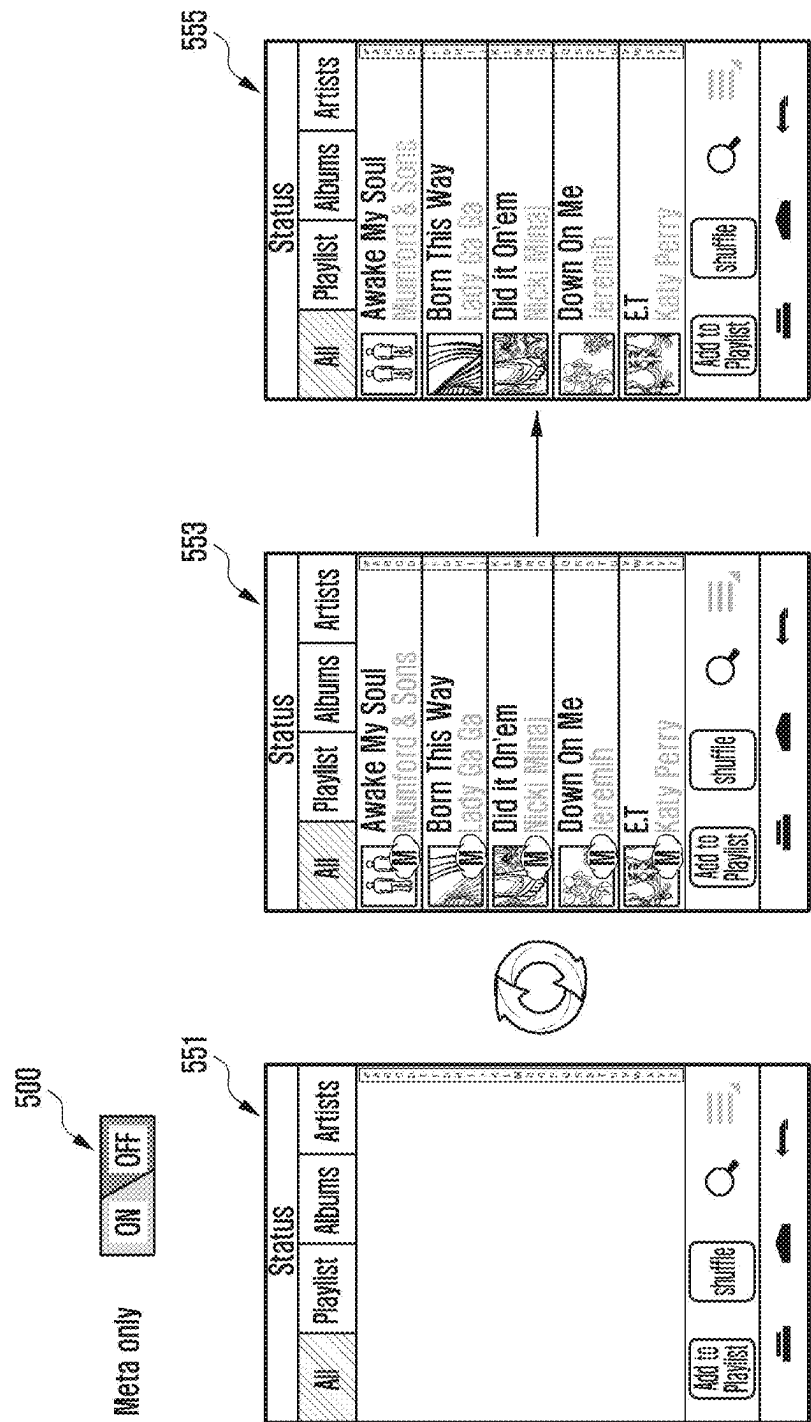


FIG. 6

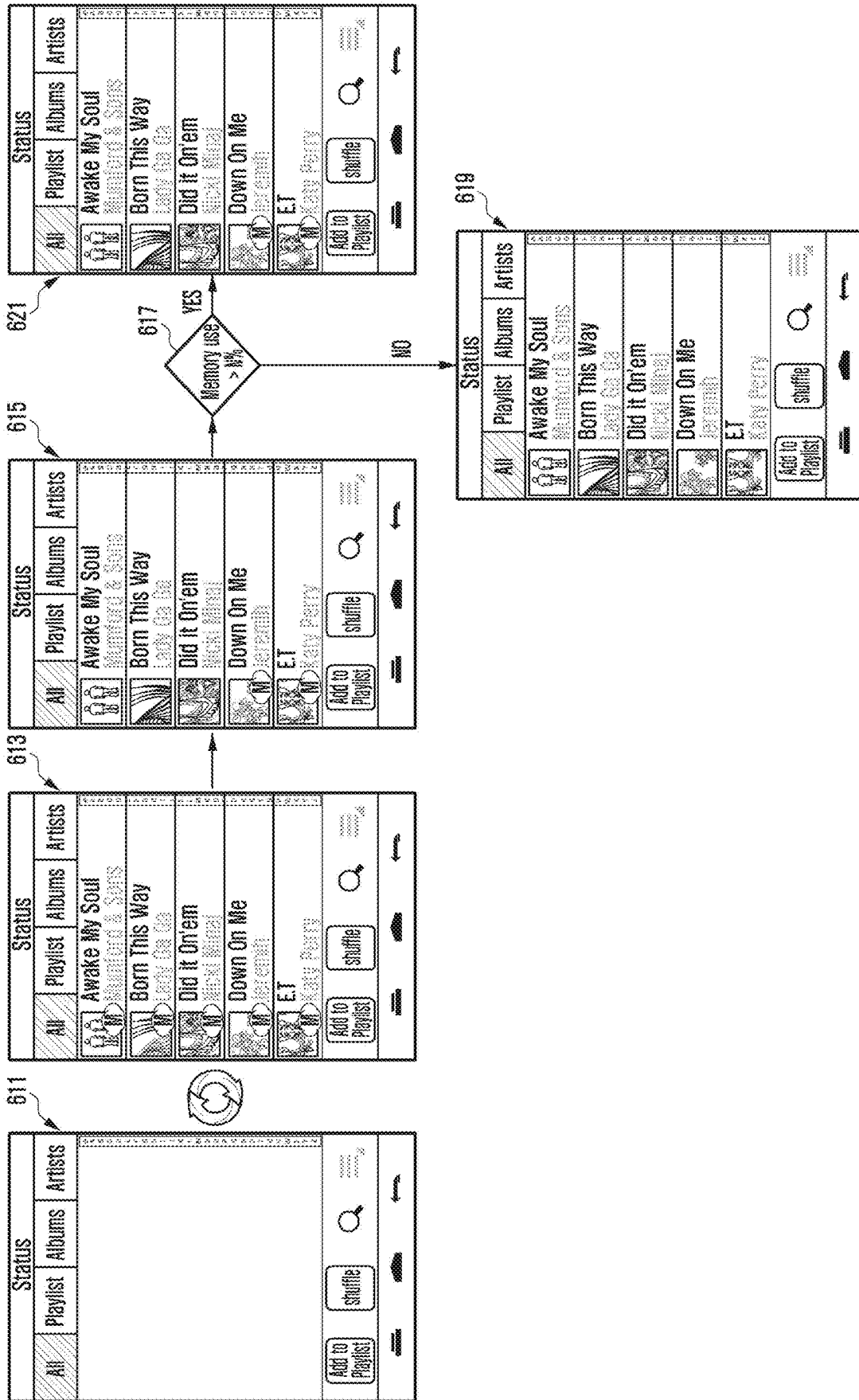


FIG. 7

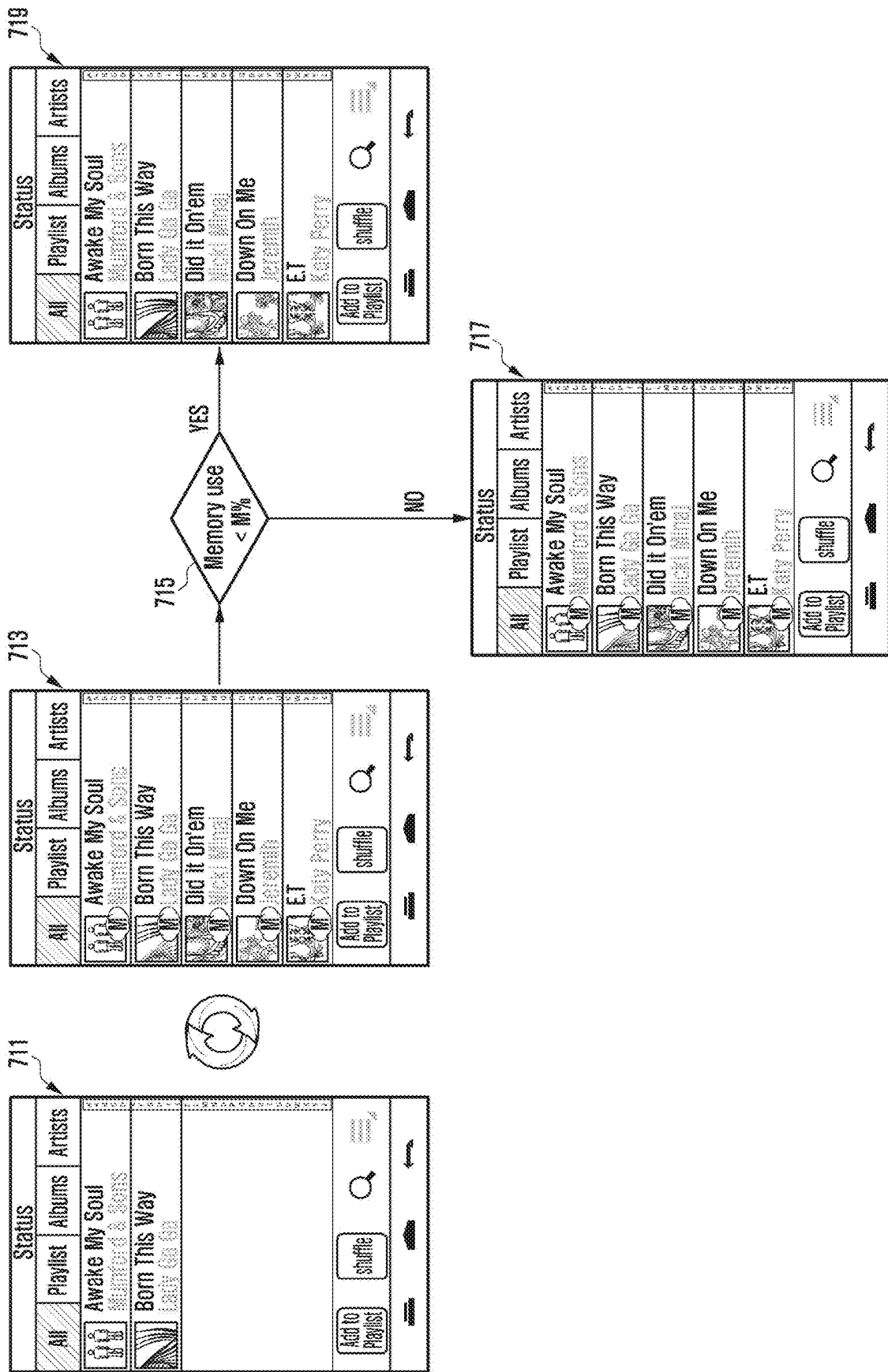


FIG. 8

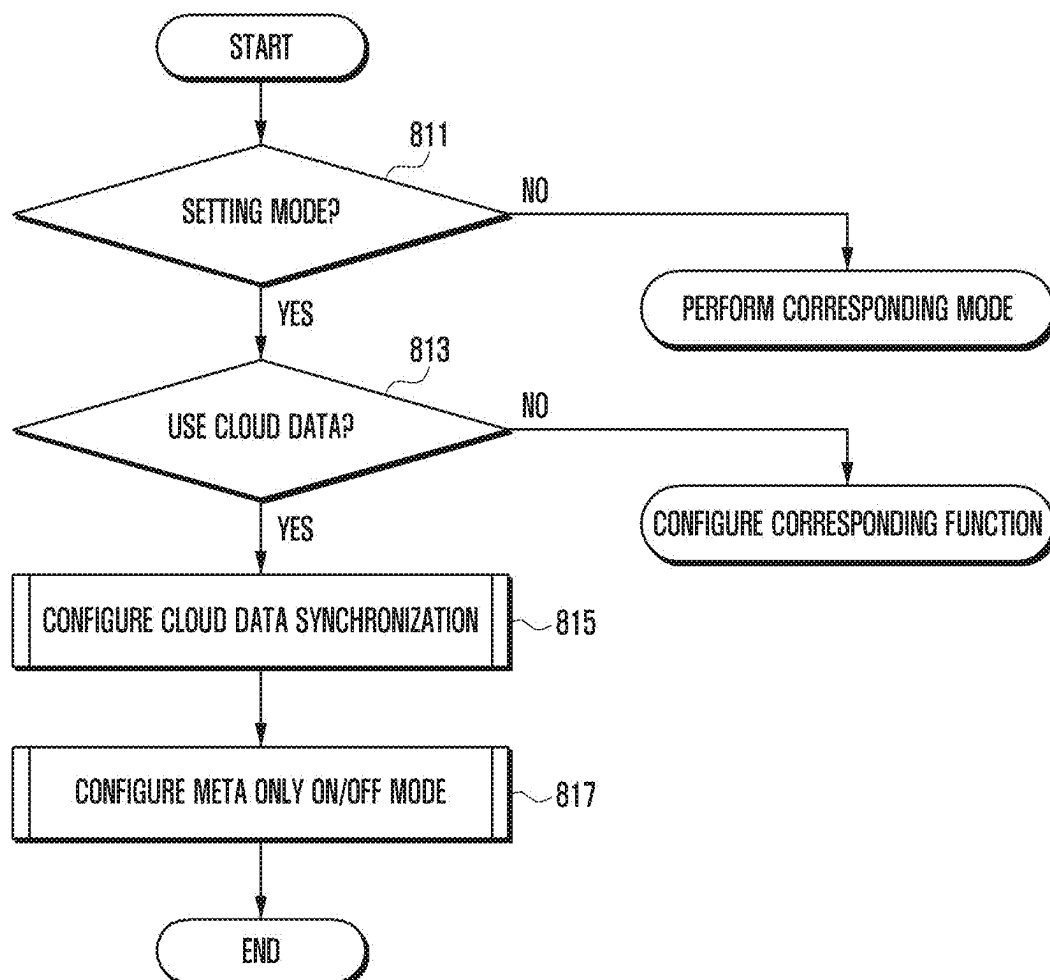


FIG. 9

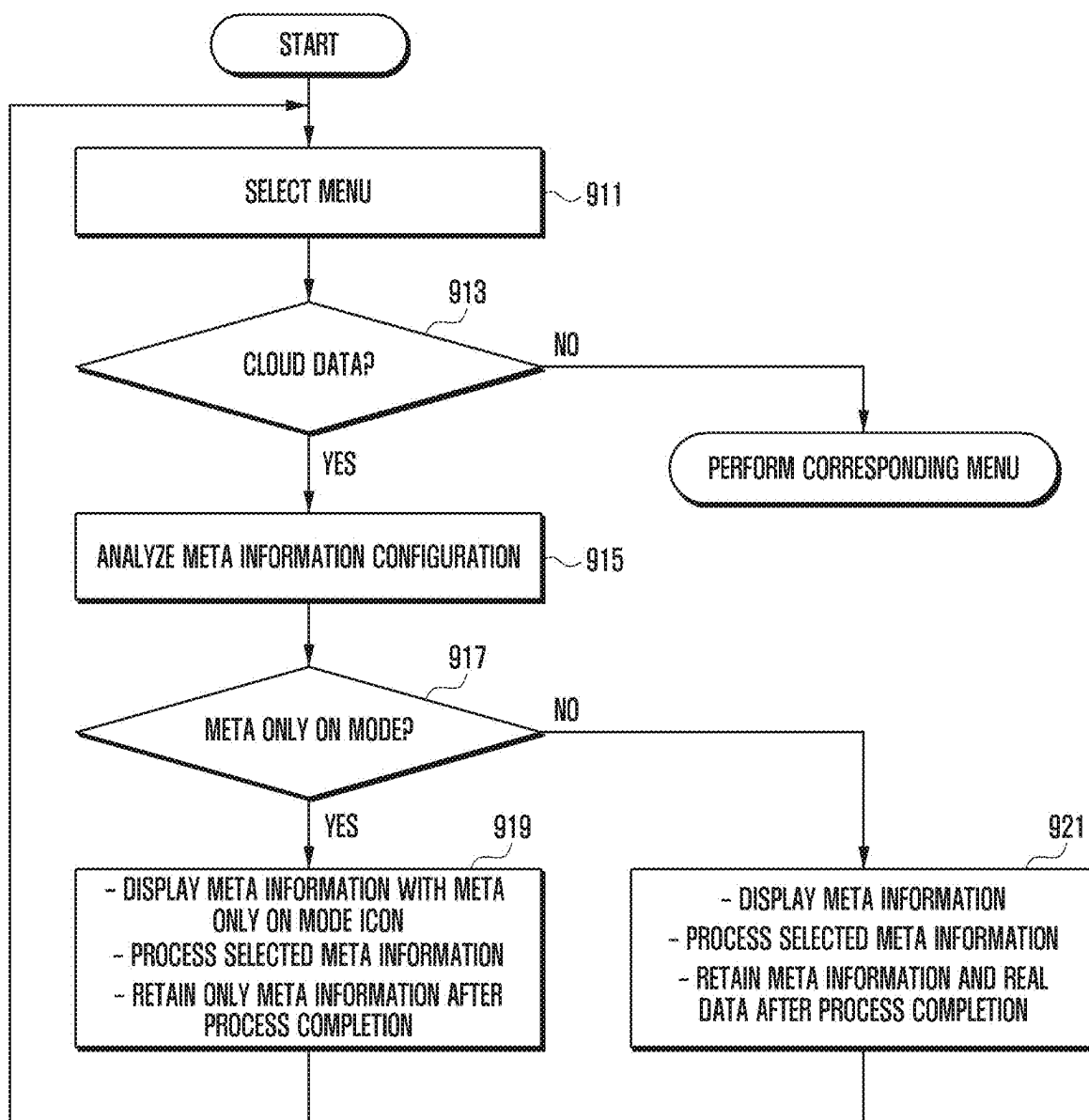


FIG. 10

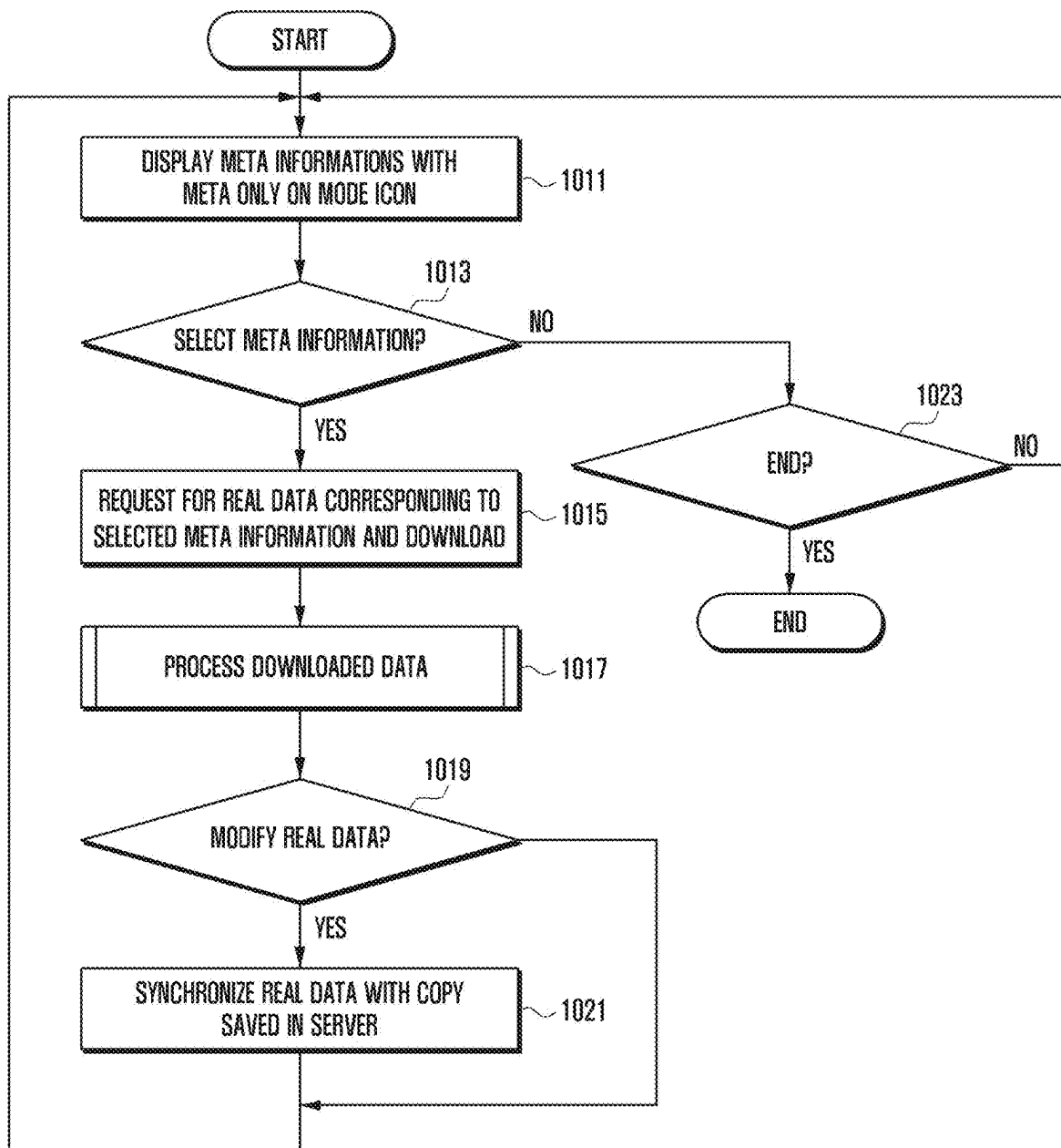


FIG. 11

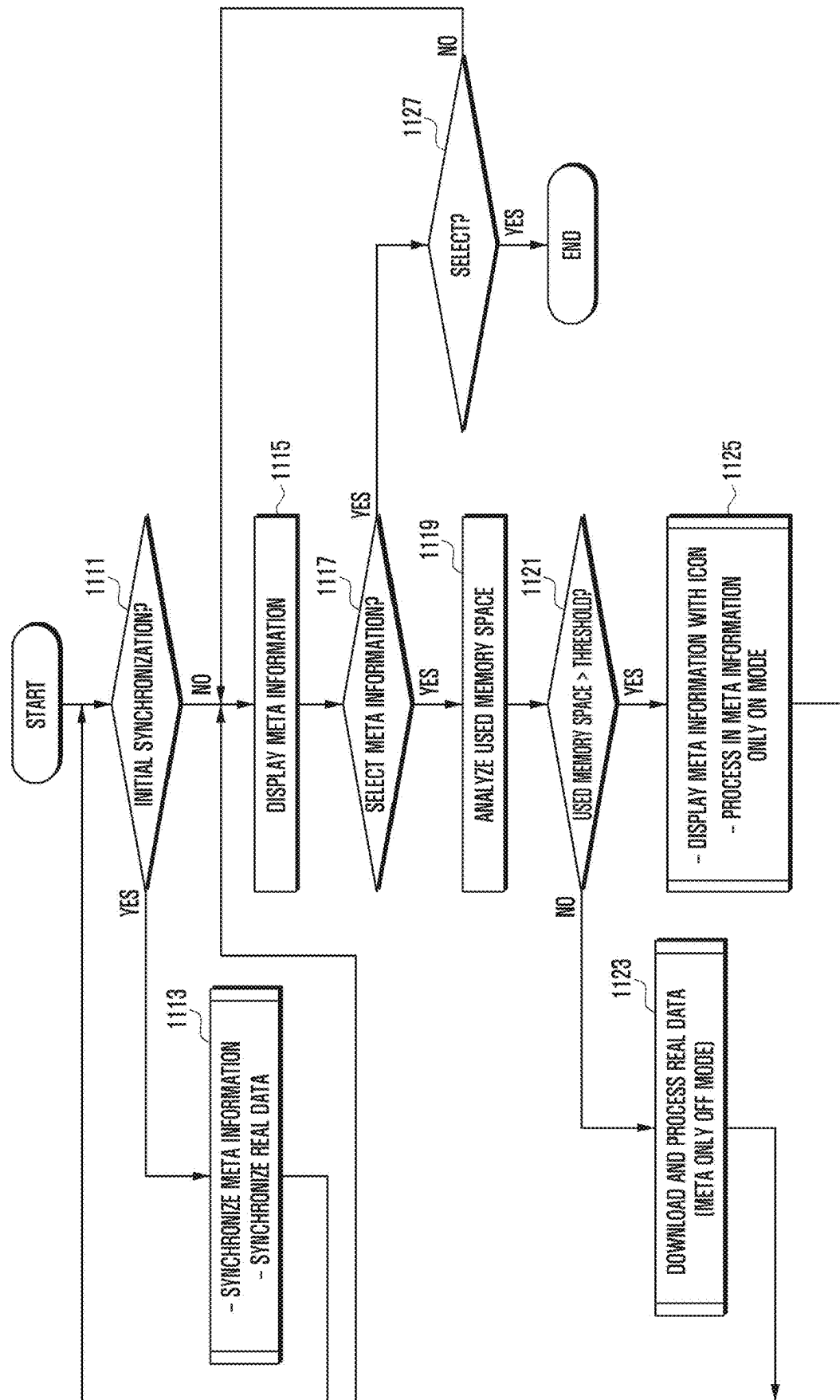


FIG. 12

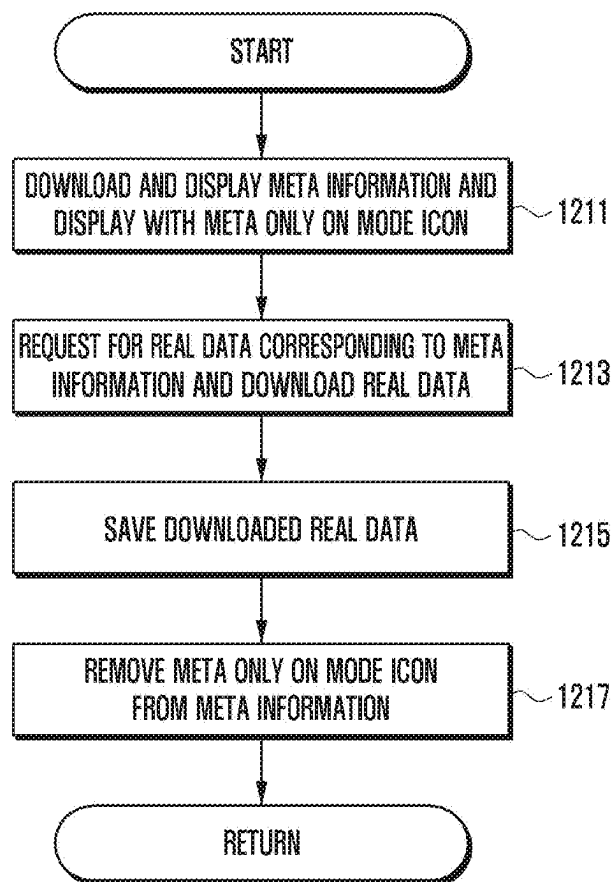


FIG. 13

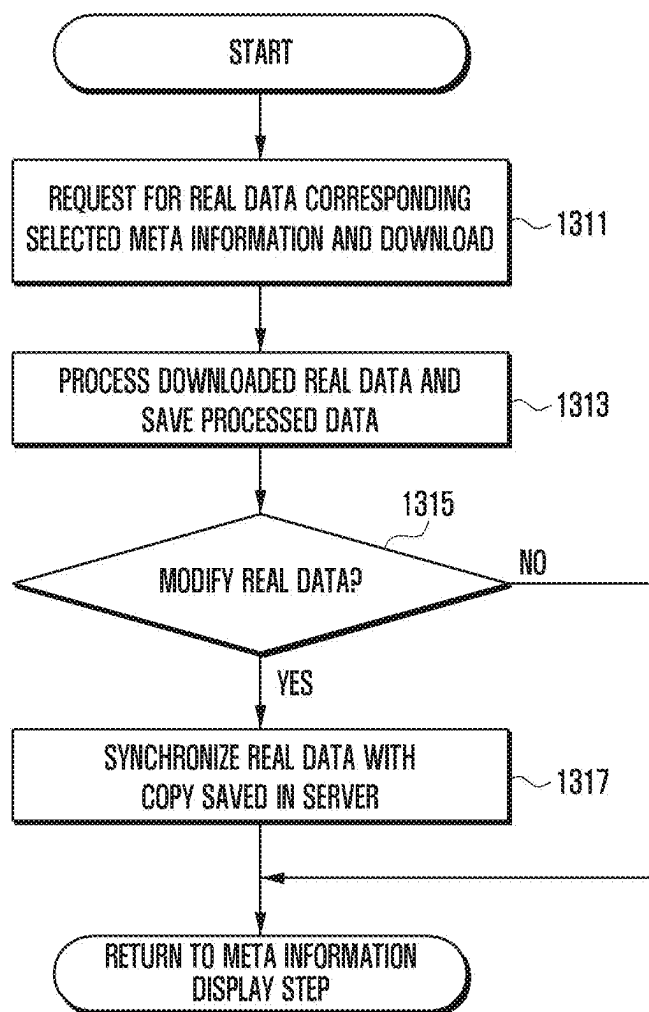
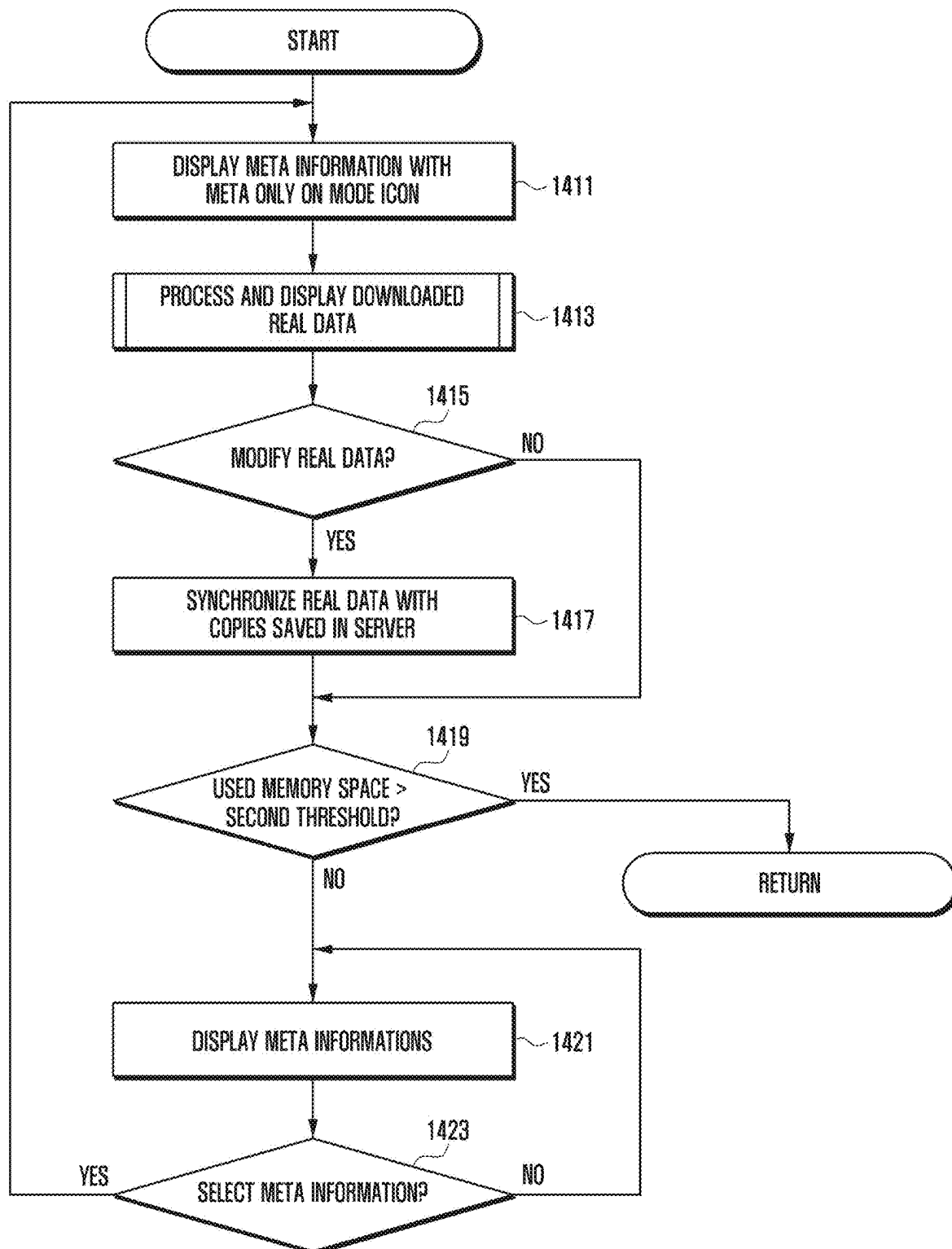


FIG. 14



1

**DATA SHARING APPARATUS AND METHOD
OF MOBILE TERMINAL****CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED
APPLICATION(S)**

This application is a continuation application of prior application Ser. No. 17/391,493 filed on Aug. 2, 2021, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,838,352 on Dec. 5, 2023; which is a continuation application of prior application Ser. No. 16/263,854 filed on Jan. 31, 2019, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 11,082,477 on Aug. 3, 2021; which is a continuation of prior application Ser. No. 15/435,594 filed on Feb. 17, 2017, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,200,450 on Feb. 5, 2019, which is a continuation of prior application Ser. No. 13/765,021 filed on Feb. 12, 2013, which issued as U.S. Pat. No. 9,584,623 on Feb. 28, 2017; and which claimed the benefit under 35 U.S.C. § 119(a) of a Korean patent application filed on Feb. 24, 2012 in the Korean Intellectual Property Office and assigned Serial number 10-2012-0019093, the entire disclosure of each of which is hereby incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION**1. Field of the Invention**

The present invention relates to a data sharing apparatus and method of a mobile terminal. More particularly, the present invention relates to an apparatus and method for sharing the data between a cloud server and at least one terminal.

2. Description of the Related Art

Typically, the terminal device such as mobile terminal is a portable device carried by a user to provide various functions including mobile communication function. The mobile terminal can be any of mobile phone, tablet PC, laptop computer, MP3 player, and the like. The mobile terminal is capable of being equipped with various functions such as communication, camera, Internet access, video playback, broadcast reception, and the like. However, for mobile terminals designed with portability as one of the most significant factors as a design consideration is limited in memory capacity. In order to overcome the memory limitation, various researches are being conducted. One of the solutions is the cloud service.

The cloud service is a means to upload the contents such as movies, pictures, music and other media files, phonebook, and the like to a server and download any of them, whenever it is necessary, using a portable terminal equipped with the communication function. In the case of using the cloud service by means of the portable terminal, the aforementioned memory shortage problem may occurs while storing the downloaded data. There is therefore a need of a method of collaboration between the portable terminal and the server to manage the saved contents efficiently.

Therefore, a need exists for an apparatus, system and method for sharing the data between a cloud server and at least one terminal. Furthermore, a need exists for an apparatus, system, and method that is capable of synchronizing the data shared between a portable terminal and a server using metadata.

The above information is presented as background information only to assist with an understanding of the present disclosure. No determination has been made, and no asser-

2

tion is made, as to whether any of the above might be applicable as prior art with regard to the present invention.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Aspects of the present invention are to address at least the above-mentioned problems and/or disadvantages and to provide at least the advantages described below. Accordingly, an aspect of the present invention is to provide a data sharing apparatus and method that is capable of synchronizing the data shared between a portable terminal and a server using metadata.

Another aspect of the present invention is to provide a data sharing apparatus and method that is capable of managing the contents shared between a portable terminal and a server with meta-information of the contents efficiently in such a way that, if the piece of meta-information is selected, the portable terminal downloads the data represented by the piece of meta-information to consume and then discards the consumed data immediately.

Another aspect of the present invention is to provide a data sharing apparatus and method that is capable of managing the contents shared between a portable terminal and a server efficiently in such a way that the portable terminal analyzes residual memory space, when a piece of meta-information is selected to download the corresponding data, and consumes and stores, if the residual memory space is enough to store the data, and, otherwise, consumes and discards the data immediately.

In accordance with an aspect of the present invention, a data sharing method of a terminal is provided. The data sharing method includes displaying, when a data type is selected on a setting menu screen of a cloud service, meta information of real data corresponding to the selected data type, the meta information being downloaded from a server; downloading, when a piece of meta information is selected, the real data corresponding to the selected piece of meta information from the server; and deleting, when the downloaded real data is consumed completely, the consumed real data.

In accordance with another aspect of the present invention, a data sharing method of a terminal is provided. The data sharing method includes configuring data types and a meta information mode for use in a cloud service; operating, when the meta information mode is set to a meta only on mode, in the meta only on mode, and operating, when the meta information mode is set to a meta only off mode, in the meta only off mode, wherein operating in the meta only on mode comprises displaying, when the meta information mode is set to a meta only on mode, meta information corresponding to data corresponding to a selected data type, downloading, when a piece of meta information is selected, the data corresponding to the selected piece of meta information from a server, and deleting the downloaded data after being consumed, and operating in the meta only off mode comprises displaying, when the meta information mode is set to a meta only off mode, the meta information corresponding to the data corresponding to the selected data type, downloading, when a piece of meta information is selected, the data corresponding to the selected meta information from the server, and storing the downloaded data after being consumed.

In accordance with still another aspect of the present invention, a data sharing method of a terminal is provided. The data sharing method includes downloading and storing meta information of data corresponding to a selected data type for cloud service from a server in an initial synchro-

nization process, displaying, when the data type is selected, the meta information of the data corresponding to the selected data type, analyzing, when a piece of the meta information is selected, used memory space, switching, when the used memory space is greater than a threshold value, from a meta only off mode to a meta only on mode to process the data in the meta only on mode, and maintaining, when the used memory space is equal to or less than the threshold value, the meta only off mode to process the data in the meta only off mode, wherein the meta only off mode synchronizes both the meta information and the corresponding data with copies saved in the server while the meta only on mode synchronizes only the meta information with copies saved in the server, the data corresponding to the meta information being processed in a cache memory and then deleted in the meta only on mode.

In accordance with still another aspect of the present invention, a terminal for sharing data with a server is provided. The terminal includes a communication unit which communicates data and meta information representing the data with the server through an Internet Protocol (IP) network, a memory having a cache region for storing the data temporarily and a cloud region for storing cloud data, an input unit which receives an input for setting a meta information mode to a meta only on mode or a meta only off mode, a display unit which displays the cloud data in one of the meta only on mode and the meta only off mode, and a control unit which controls the terminal in the meta only on mode to display, when the meta information mode is set to a meta only on mode, meta information corresponding to data corresponding to a selected data type, to download, when a piece of meta information is selected, the data corresponding to the selected piece of meta information from a server, and to delete the downloaded data after being consumed, and which controls the terminal in the meta only off mode to display, when the meta information mode is set to a meta only off mode, the meta information corresponding to the data corresponding to the selected data type, to download, when a piece of meta information is selected, the data corresponding to the selected piece of meta information from the server, and store the downloaded data after being consumed.

Other aspects, advantages, and salient features of the invention will become apparent to those skilled in the art from the following detailed description, which, taken in conjunction with the annexed drawings, discloses exemplary embodiments of the invention.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

The above and other aspects, features, and advantages of certain exemplary embodiments of the present invention will be more apparent from the following description taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which:

FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating the architecture of a cloud service system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of a terminal according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIGS. 3A and 3B are diagrams illustrating screens for configuring data synchronization for use in data synchronization between a terminal and a server according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIGS. 4A and 4B are diagrams illustrating exemplary screens displayed in a meta only on mode of a terminal according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIGS. 5A and 5B are diagrams illustrating exemplary screens displayed in a meta only off mode of a terminal according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 6 is a diagram illustrating exemplary screens displayed when a terminal switches from a meta only off mode to a meta only on mode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 7 is a diagram illustrating exemplary screens displayed when a terminal switches from a meta only on mode to a meta only off mode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 8 is a flowchart illustrating a procedure for synchronizing meta information and data types for cloud service between a terminal and a server according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 9 is a flowchart illustrating a terminal procedure for executing a cloud service between a terminal and a server according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 10 is a flowchart illustrating a terminal procedure for processing a meta only on mode cloud service according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 11 is a flowchart illustrating a terminal procedure for processing a meta only off mode cloud service according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 12 is a flowchart illustrating a detail of an initial synchronization process in a meta only off mode such as, for example, the initial synchronization process of step 1113 of FIG. 11, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention;

FIG. 13 is a flowchart illustrating a detail of a real data download process when a used memory space is less than a threshold value in a meta only off mode such as, for example, the real data download process of step 1123 of FIG. 11, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention; and

FIG. 14 is a flowchart illustrating a detail of switching from a meta only off mode to a meta only on mode when a used memory space is greater than a threshold value such as, for example, the switching from the meta only off mode to the meta only on mode of step 1125 of FIG. 11, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Throughout the drawings, it should be noted that like reference numbers are used to depict the same or similar elements, features, and structures.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

The following description with reference to the accompanying drawings is provided to assist in a comprehensive understanding of exemplary embodiments of the invention as defined by the claims and their equivalents. It includes various specific details to assist in that understanding but these are to be regarded as merely exemplary. Accordingly, those of ordinary skill in the art in the art will recognize that various changes and modifications of the embodiments described herein can be made without departing from the scope and spirit of the invention. In addition, descriptions of well-known functions and constructions may be omitted for clarity and conciseness.

5

The terms and words used in the following description and claims are not limited to the bibliographical meanings, but, are merely used by the inventor to enable a clear and consistent understanding of the invention. Accordingly, it should be apparent to those skilled in the art that the following description of exemplary embodiments of the present invention is provided for illustration purpose only and not for the purpose of limiting the invention as defined by the appended claims and their equivalents.

It is to be understood that the singular forms “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural referents unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Thus, for example, reference to “a component surface” includes reference to one or more of such surfaces.

In the following description, numerous specific details are provided, such as memory utilization, to provide a thorough understanding of exemplary embodiments of the present invention. One skilled in the relevant art will recognize, however, that an exemplary embodiment of the present invention can be practiced without one or more of the specific details, or with other apparatus, systems, assemblies, methods, components, materials, parts, and/or the like. In other instances, well-known structures, materials, or operations are not specifically shown or described in detail to avoid obscuring aspects of exemplary embodiments of the present invention.

Exemplary embodiments of the present invention use meta-information in the cloud data sync method to provide the server and the terminal with the same view. According to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the cloud data sync method is provided with a meta only on mode and a meta only off mode. Here, the meta-information is the information about certain data. As an example, the meta-information includes only the basic information such as thumbnail and data name about certain data. The term ‘data’ (hereinafter, referred to as real data) denotes the object represented by the meta-information. Here, the meta only on mode is the operation mode in which the portable terminal has only the meta-information synchronized with the copies stored in the server and downloads the real data represented by the meta-information selected in the portable terminal from the server, the downloaded real data being consumed and discarded. The meta only off mode is the operation mode in which the portable terminal has the meta-information synchronized with the copies stored in the server and analyzes the residual memory space, when a piece of meta information is selected, to store, if the residual memory space is enough, the downloaded real data and, otherwise, transition to the meta only on mode. According to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the meta information processed in the meta only on mode is expressed in the form of an icon indicating that only the meta information exists (hereinafter, referred to as meta only on mode icon).

FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating the architecture of a cloud service system according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Referring to FIG. 1, the terminals **101**, **102**, and **10N** connect to the server **120** through the Internet **110**. Here, each of the terminals **101**, **102**, and **10N** can be any of a mobile phone, a tablet Personal Computer (PC), a laptop computer, an MP3 player, and the like. The server **120** includes an application processor **123** for processing various types of contents and a database **125** for storing meta information of the contents and the real data represented by the meta information.

6

The above-structured cloud service system has been evolved to the current platform service. Unlike the conventional personal cloud service providing storage space in the form of the conventional web hard, the recent cloud service has been upgraded as a platform service capable of supporting various types of software applications. The cloud service system is capable of supporting the applications through the cooperation among the telecommunication carriers and application service providers. For example, a client is capable of working with documents by means of a smart-phone or tablet PC as well as desktop PC at office or home without extra software installation. This means that the software with which the user has work can be used in another PC, portable terminal operating on the android, iOS platform, or the like, tablet PC, or laptop computer only by downloading the corresponding document application without installation. With the diversification of such applications, the cloud service system is also evolving to process the application data, especially the entertainment data such as movie, game, document, music, picture files, and the like.

In the case of interoperating with the service based on the Digital Living Network Alliance converging wired and wireless communications, this make it possible to transmit and share the contents through a home network. For example, the cloud service can be used for sharing contents stored in the cloud storage among the devices connected through wired and wireless links.

FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration of a terminal according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention. As an example, the terminal can be one of the terminals **101**, **102**, and **10N** illustrated in FIG. 1, and FIG. 2 is directed to the case in which the terminal is a mobile phone.

Referring to FIG. 2, the first communication unit **220** and the second communication unit **230** are responsible for radio communication of the terminal in the communication network. As an example, the communication network can be a cellular communication network or an Internet Protocol (IP) communication network. Each of the first and second communication units **220** and **230** may include a transmitter having a frequency up converter for up-converting a baseband signal to a Radio Frequency (RF) band signal and a power amplifier and a receiver having a low noise amplifier for low noise amplifying the received RF signal and a frequency down converter for down converting the RF signal to a baseband signal. Each of the first and second communication units **220** and **230** may also include a modulator for modulating the transmission signal and delivering the modulated signal to the transmitter and a demodulator for demodulating the signal output by the receiver. As an example, the modulator/demodulator may modulate/demodulate Wideband Code Division Multiple Access (WCDMA), Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA), Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM), Long Term Evolution (LTE), WiFi, Wireless Broadband (WiBro), or Worldwide Interoperability for Microwave Access (WiMax) signal, and/or the like.

The control unit **200** controls overall operations of the terminal and data communication in connection with a communication network by means of the first and second communication units **220** and **230** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

The memory **210** can be divided into a program memory for storing the Operating System (OS) of the terminal and application programs and a data memory for storing install data and application data generated in using the application programs. According to an exemplary embodiment of the

present invention, the memory **210** may include a region for processing cloud service data (hereinafter, referred to as cloud region). In the case of the meta only on mode, the cloud region is not used.

The input unit **240** is capable of receiving a command input for controlling the operation of the terminal and data. The display unit **250** is capable of displaying visual data under the control of the control unit **200**. As an example, the input unit **240** and the display unit **250** may be integrated into a touchscreen panel. The camera **260** is capable of taking a picture and, if necessary, uploading the picture to a server under the control of the control unit **200**.

Each of the first and second communication units **220** and **230** is capable of connecting to a base station through a radio link for voice and data communication and/or connecting to an Internet Protocol (IP) network for data communication. The communication unit connected to a base station is capable of including a modulator/demodulator for processing 3rd Generation (3G) or 4th Generation (4G) communication system signal for providing voice and data communication services, and the communication unit connected to an IP network is capable of accessing an Internet server for data communication service. In the following description, it is assumed that the first communication unit **220** is the communication unit for establishing a connection to the IP network **110** with a modem supporting at least one of WiFi, WiBro, and WiMax technologies. In addition, it is assumed that the second communication unit **230** is the communication unit for establishing a connection to a base station with a modem supporting at least one of GSM, CDMA, WCDMA, LTE technologies, and the like for voice and data communication. As an example, the second communication unit **230** is capable of connecting to the IP network via a base station. Although FIG. 2 is directed to the case in which the terminal is equipped with two communication units, it is also possible the terminal is equipped with additional communication units for connecting to other communication systems (e.g., GSM, WCDMA, LTE, and the like base stations). For example, although the first and second communication units are depicted in FIG. 2, the terminal may be equipped with three or more communication units.

The above structured terminal operates as a client of the server **120**, and the server **120** and the client (i.e., the terminal) has the same menu structure of the cloud data as synchronized. The server **120** stores the meta information synchronized with the copies stored in the terminal and the real data represented by the meta information, while the terminal stores only the meta information or both the meta information and the real data.

According to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the above structured terminal processes the real data based on the meta information in cloud data synch procedure to provide differentiated user scenarios of the meta data only on/off mode and switches between the meta data only on mode and meta data off mode depending on the residual device memory space.

In order to accomplish this, the above structured terminal displays and processes the real data stored in the server using the meta information representing the real data and synchronized with the copies stored in the terminal. The terminal is operating in one of the meta only on mode and meta only off mode that can be configured in the settings menu and, especially when it is operating in the meta only on mode, the cloud data synchronization is performed at the meta information level. This is advantageous in application to the low end terminal or low memory capacity terminal and also applicable to the high end terminal for avoiding memory

shortage. If a specific piece of meta information is selected in the meta only on mode, the terminal downloads the real data corresponding to the meta information from the server and processes the downloaded data in the cache region.

If the meta only on mode is terminated, the terminal formats the cache region to secure the space processing another file. In the case of the device having no memory space for use as the device cache region, it is possible to use the space of an external memory card.

In the case that the terminal is operating in the meta only off mode, the cloud data synchronization is performed at both the meta information level and the real data level. In this case, the terminal performs synchronization of all data saved in the cloud server **120** based on the initial meta information and then downloads the real data corresponding to the meta information in sequence provided the memory **210** (e.g., it can be the cloud region) has space (e.g., the meta data is replaced by the real data). At this time, the tolerable range for replacement by the real data can be a predetermined threshold value of $n\%$ (e.g., 85%) and, if it exceeds $n\%$, the meta information are no longer replaced. In the case that the user deletes the cloud data (e.g., the data stored in the cloud region) such that the used memory space of the terminal become equal to or less than $m\%$ (e.g., 70%), the terminal is capable of replacing the meta information with the corresponding real data. In the case that a certain piece of meta information is selected before the replacement with the real data, the corresponding meta information is replaced with the corresponding real data first.

FIGS. 3A and 3B are diagrams illustrating screens for configuring data synchronization for use in data synchronization between a terminal and a server according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Referring to FIGS. 3A and 3B, if a setting menu is selected by the user, the control unit **200** controls the display unit **250** to display a setting menu list as shown in FIG. 3A and, if a cloud synchronization menu item is selected from the setting menu list, controls the display unit **250** to display a sync setting menu screen as shown in FIG. 3B. The sync setting menu screen is provided with a list of the content items with respective on/off options. The list includes the contents items of music, video, picture, document, etc. that can be synchronized between the terminal and the server. If the option of a content item is set to on, the meta information belonging to the content item is synchronized between the terminal and the server **120** in the meta only on mode and both the meta information belonging to the content item and the real data corresponding to the meta information are synchronized between the terminal and the server **120** in the meta only off mode.

A description is made of the terminal operation in the meta only off mode hereinafter in detail.

FIGS. 4A and 4B are diagrams illustrating exemplary screens displayed in a meta only on mode of a terminal according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention. In particular, FIG. 4A is directed to the meta only on mode for picture items, and FIG. 4B is directed to the meta only on mode for music items.

Referring to FIG. 4A, if the picture option is set to On in the meta only on mode, all pictures are synchronized by corresponding meta information between the terminal and the server. In this state, if a picture menu item (e.g., gallery menu item) is selected, the control unit **200** controls the display unit **250** to display a picture menu screen as denoted by reference number **411** with the indication of the meta only on mode as denoted by reference number **400**. Afterward, the control unit **200** controls to display the meta information

of the pictures as denoted by reference number **413** with the indication icon indicating the meta only on mode (e.g., in FIG. **4A**, indication of "M"). Here, the meta information of each picture may include a thumbnail image and exchangeable image file format (e.g., exif) information and can be presented as the thumbnail image as denoted by reference number **413**. In this state, if a specific thumbnail image is selected (e.g., the meta information of specific picture), the control unit **200** detects the selection and requests the server **120** for the real data represented by the meta information and controls the display unit **250** to display the downloaded image to be fit to the screen horizontally as denoted by reference number **415**. At this time, the downloaded picture is executed in the cache region of the memory **210** to be displayed on the screen along with the meta only on icon "M" as shown in the screen **415**. If it is requested to terminate displaying the picture corresponding to the selected meta information, the thumbnail view screen reappears as denoted by reference number **417**. At this time, the real data executed in the cache region of the memory **210** is deleted for next data processing.

Referring to FIG. **4B**, if the picture option is set to On in the meta only on mode, all music are synchronized by corresponding meta information between the terminal and the server. In this state, if a music menu item (e.g., music collection menu item) is selected, the control unit **200** controls the display unit **250** to display a music menu screen as denoted by reference number **451** with the indication of the meta only on mode as denoted by reference number **400**. Afterward, the control unit **200** controls to display the meta information of the music as denoted by reference number **453** with the indication icon indicating the meta only on mode (e.g., in FIG. **4B**, indication of "M"). Here, the meta information of each music item may include a thumbnail image and exchangeable image file format (e.g., exif) information and can be presented as the thumbnail image as denoted by reference number **453**. In this state, if a specific thumbnail image is selected (e.g., the meta information of specific music item), the control unit **200** detects the selection and requests the server **120** for the real data represented by the meta information and controls to play the corresponding music item and controls the display unit **250** to display the downloaded image to be fit to the screen horizontally as denoted by reference number **455**. At this time, the downloaded music item and/or corresponding image is executed in the cache region of the memory **210** to be played and/or displayed on the screen along with the meta only on icon "M" as shown in the screen **455**. If it is requested to terminate playing the music item and/or displaying the image corresponding to the selected meta information, the thumbnail view screen reappears as denoted by reference number **457**. At this time, the real data executed in the cache region of the memory **210** is deleted for next data processing.

In the case that a music menu item is selected, the selected music item is processed in the meta only on mode. As described above, if cloud service items (e.g., Photo, Music, Video, Document, and the like) are selected, the meta only on mode operations are applied to all contents in the same manner such that, although the file corresponding to the selected meta information is executed, the terminal does not replace the meta information with the real data (e.g., does not store the real data in the memory **120**) but maintains only the meta information. This technique is advantageous to the low end and low capacity terminals and also can be applied to the higher end terminals to avoid memory shortage problem.

A description is made of the terminal operation in the meta only off mode hereinafter in detail.

FIGS. **5A** and **5B** are diagrams illustrating exemplary screens displayed in the meta only off mode of the terminal according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention. In particular, FIG. **5A** is directed to the initial synchronization procedure for synchronizing pictures between the terminal and the server, and FIG. **5B** is directed to the initial synchronization procedure for synchronizing music files between the terminal and the server. FIG. **6** is a diagram illustrating exemplary screens displayed when a terminal switches from a meta only off mode to a meta only on mode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, and FIG. **7** is a diagram illustrating exemplary screens displayed when a terminal switches from a meta only on mode to a meta only off mode according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Referring to FIGS. **5A** and **5B**, the data synchronization, in the meta only off mode, is performed in such a way that both the meta information and the real data stored in the terminal are synchronized with the copies stored in the server. If the meta only off mode is selected as denoted by reference number **500**, the control unit **200** displays an indicator indicating that the terminal operates in the meta only off mode as denoted by reference number **511** and **551**. Afterward, the control unit **200** displays the meta information of the items belonging to the selected data type on the screen as denoted by reference number **513** and **553** along with the meta information indication icons. After displaying the meta information, the control unit **200** controls the first communication unit **220** or the second communication unit **230** to request the server **120** to transmit the real data corresponding to the respective meta information and stores the real data downloaded from the server **120** in the memory **120**. Once the real data has been stored, the control unit **200** controls such that the meta information indication icons disappear on the display unit **250** as denoted by reference number **515** and **555**. If the meta only off mode is selected as described above, the control unit **200** downloads the real data corresponding to the meta information displayed on the screen to replace the meta information with the downloaded real data in sequence.

Referring to FIG. **6**, the control unit **200** displays an indicator indicating that the terminal operates in the meta only off mode as denoted by reference number **611**. Afterward, the control unit **200** displays the meta information of the items belonging to the selected data type on the screen as denoted by reference number **613** along with the meta information indication icons. After displaying the meta information, the control unit **200** controls the first communication unit **220** or the second communication unit **230** to request the server **120** to transmit the real data corresponding to the respective meta information and stores the real data downloaded from the server **120** in the memory **120**. Once the real data has been stored, the control unit **200** controls such that the meta information indication icons disappear on the display unit **250** as denoted by reference number **615**. According to exemplary embodiments of the present invention, in the state in which the real data corresponding to the meta information have been downloaded, if a piece of meta information is selected on the screen as denoted by reference number **615**, the selected meta information is replaced by the corresponding real data which is stored in the memory **120**. In this case, the memory **210** of the terminal stores the real data and this may cause residual memory shortage (meta only (off)—memory full (memory >N %)). In order to solve this problem, the control unit **110**

11

analyzes, when a piece of meta information is selected, the residual memory space of the memory 210 as denoted by reference number 617 to maintain, when there is sufficient residual memory space, the meta only off mode to download the real data corresponding to the meta information as denoted by reference number 619 and, otherwise, switches to the meta only on mode as denoted by reference number 621. For example, the terminal operating in the meta only off mode replaces the meta information with the real data and, if the real data stored in the memory 210 is greater than a predetermined size (N %), stops downloading the real data and switches the operation mode from the meta only off mode to the meta only on mode.

Referring to FIG. 7, after switching from the meta only off mode to the meta only on mode, the operation mode may be switched again from the meta only on mode to the meta only off mode. Reference number 711 denotes that the control unit 200 executes the meta only off mode. As an example, when the used storage space of the memory 210 is over N %, the control unit 200 executes the meta only on mode, and the meta information is displayed on the display unit 250 along with the meta only on mode indication icon as denoted by reference number 713. At this time, the user is capable of deleting specific files to maintain the used storage space of the memory below N %. However, it is not mandatory to replace the meta information to the real data when the used storage space is equal to or less than N %. This is because the memory full situation may occur so frequently around the N %. In order to overcome this problem, the control unit 200 controls such that when the used storage space become less than the N % in the meta only on mode, the meta only on mode is maintained as denoted by reference number 717. In the case that the used storage space of the memory 210 is less than M %, the control unit 200 detects this as denoted by reference number 715 and executes the meta only off mode as denoted by reference number 719 such that it becomes possible to download the real data corresponding to the meta information. As an example, M % may be set to a value less than N %, and it is assumed that N is 85 and M is 70.

FIG. 8 is a flowchart illustrating a procedure for synchronizing meta information and data types for cloud service between a terminal and a server according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Referring to FIG. 8, if the user selects a setting menu using the input unit 240, the control unit 200 detects user input at step 811 and displays the setting menu screen on the display unit 250 as shown in FIG. 3A. If a cloud service item is selected on the setting menu screen, the control unit 200 detects this selection at step 813 and displays a cloud service setting menu screen as shown in FIG. 3B. The cloud service setting menu screen can be provided per data type or integrally to list all of the data types on a single page as shown in FIG. 3B. According to the user input, the control unit 200 sets the data type to be synchronized through the cloud service and the meta only on mode at steps 815 and 817. As an example, the data types may include music, video, picture, document, and the like that can be turned on individually for synchronizing the data belonging to the selected data type between the terminal and the cloud server. As described above, the terminal can be configured to operate in one of the meta only on mode and the meta only off mode.

FIG. 9 is a flowchart illustrating a terminal procedure for executing a cloud service between a terminal and a server according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

12

Referring to FIG. 9, if the user selects a menu item, the control unit 200 detects the menu selection and determines whether the selected menu is the cloud service setting menu at step 911. As an example, the cloud service setting menu is displayed in the form of a cloud service setting menu screen as shown in FIG. 3B. If a data type (e.g., picture, video, music, document, or the like) is selected on the cloud service setting menu screen, the control unit 200 detects this selection at step 913 and analyzes the meta information utilization mode at step 915 and determines whether the meta information utilization mode is the meta only on mode or the meta only off mode at step 917.

If it is determined that the current meta information utilization mode is the meta only on mode at step 917, the controls unit 200 downloads the meta information of the enabled data types, displays the corresponding meta information with the meta only on mode indicator icon, and deletes the downloaded real data after consumption to maintain only the corresponding meta information at step 919. Otherwise, if it is determined that the current meta information utilization mode is the meta only off mode at step 917, the control unit 200 downloads the meta information of the data belonging to the selected data type, displays the downloaded meta information, downloads, if a specific piece of meta information is selected, the real data corresponding to the selected meta information, and stores the downloaded real data in the memory 120.

FIG. 10 is a flowchart illustrating a terminal procedure for processing a meta only on mode cloud service according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Referring to FIG. 10, when the meta only on mode is activated, the control unit 100 displays a list of the data items (i.e., the meta information corresponding to the data belonging to the selected data type) on the display unit 250 at step 1011. The meta information are displayed along with the meta only on indication icon as shown in FIGS. 4A and 4B. In the state in which the meta information is displayed on the screen as denoted by reference numbers 413 of FIG. 4A and 453 of FIG. 4B, if a specific piece of meta information is selected by means of the input unit 250, the control unit 200 detects this selection at step 1013 and requests the server 120 to transmit the real data corresponding to the selected meta information and downloads the real data, the downloaded real data being buffered in the cache region of the memory 120, at step 1015. Next, the control unit 200 processes the downloaded real data at step 1017. At this time, if the downloaded real data is a picture, the control unit 200 controls to display the picture on the display unit 205 in a full screen view as denoted by reference number 415 and, otherwise if the downloaded real data is a music file, play the music file with the presentation of the meta information of the music file (e.g., text information, thumbnail image, song title, singer, and the like) on the display unit 250 at step 1017. At this time, the real data may be changed in processing. For example, the user may delete the real data or add new information to the real data.

If a certain change occurs in the real data, the control unit 200 detects the change at step 1019 and uploads the changed real data to the server 120 to synchronizes the meta information and real data with the copies saved in the server 120 at step 1021. After processing the real data (it can be the tapping action in FIGS. 4A and 4B), the control unit 200 deletes the real data buffered in the cache region for next process and returns the procedure to step 1011 to displays the meta information in the meta only on mode (see step 417 of FIG. 4A and 457 of FIG. 4B). At this time, if a termination

13

request is input by means of the input unit **240**, the control unit **200** detects at step **1023** and ends the meta only on mode operation.

As described above, the terminal operating in the meta only on mode displays the meta information of the data belonging to the selected data type along with the meta only on mode indicator icon. If a specific piece of meta information is selected, the terminal requests the server **120** for the real data corresponding to the meta information, downloads the real data, displays the downloaded real data, and processes the real data according to the user's intention. Afterward, if the real data is processed completely with a certain change, the terminal uploads the changed real data to the server **110**.

FIG. **11** is a flowchart illustrating a terminal procedure for processing a meta only off mode cloud service according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Referring to FIG. **11**, the control unit **200** monitors to detect a synchronization request in the meta only off mode and, if the synchronization request is detected, determines whether the synchronization is an initial synchronization at step **1111**. If it is the initial synchronization, the control unit **200** downloads the meta information of the data belonging to the selected data type and then the real data corresponding to the meta information at step **1113**. Once the initial synchronization has completed, the terminal and the server **120** are in the state in which the meta information and the real data belonging to the selected data type are synchronized.

If a data item is selected in this state, the control unit **200** controls to display the meta information of the selected data item at step **1115**. If the meta information is not selected, the control unit **200** controls to determine whether to terminate the process or to return to step **1115** at which the meta information is displayed. If the meta information is selected the control unit **200** detects this at step **1117** and analyzes the data amount stored in the cloud region of the memory **120** (used memory space) at step **1119**. At this time, if the used memory space is not greater than a predetermined threshold, the control unit **200** detects this at step **1121** and maintains the meta only off mode at step **1123**. In the meta only off mode, the terminal downloads the real data corresponding to the selected meta information as denoted by reference number **619** of FIG. **6**, displays and processes the downloaded real data, stores the processed result in the memory **220**, and uploads the processed data to the server **120**. If the used storage space is greater than the threshold value, the control unit **200** detects this at step **1121** and proceeds to step **1125** at which the control unit **200** switches to the meta only on mode as denoted by reference number **621** of FIG. **6**.

FIG. **12** is a flowchart illustrating a detail of an initial synchronization process in a meta only off mode such as, for example, the initial synchronization process of step **1113** of FIG. **11**, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Referring to FIG. **12**, the control unit requests the server **120** for the meta information representing the data belonging to the selected data type and displays the downloaded meta information along with the meta only on mode indicator icon on the screen as denoted by reference numbers **513** of FIG. **5A** and **553** of FIG. **5B** at step **1211**. Afterward, the control unit **200** requests the server **120** for the real data corresponding to the displayed meta information at step **1213** and stores the downloaded real data in the memory **210** at step **1215**. Next, at step **1217**, the control unit **200** controls such that the meta only on mode indicator icon disappears from the meta information of which real data have been downloaded and

14

stored in the memory **210** as shown on the screen denoted by reference numbers **515** of FIG. **5A** and **555** of FIG. **5B**. Once the initial synchronization has been completed, the terminal and the server **120** acquire synchronization of both the meta information and the real data. Afterward, if a piece of meta information is selected, the terminal analyzes the used memory space and processes the real data according to the analysis result.

FIG. **13** is a flowchart illustrating a detail of a real data download process when a used memory space is less than a threshold value in a meta only off mode such as, for example, the real data download process of step **1123** of FIG. **11**, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

Referring to FIG. **13**, the control unit **200** requests the server **120** to transmit the real data corresponding to the selected meta information at step **1311** and displays and processes the downloaded real data and then stores the processed real data in the memory **210** at step **1313**. Afterward, if a change occurs in the real data, the control unit **200** detects the change at step **1315** and uploads the changed real data to the server **120** to acquire synchronization of the meta information and the corresponding real data between the terminal and the server **120** at step **1317** if there is a detected change in the real data. Otherwise, if no change is detected at step **1315**, the process returns to displaying meta information.

FIG. **14** is a flowchart illustrating a detail of switching from a meta only off mode to a meta only on mode when a used memory space is greater than a threshold value such as, for example, the switching from the meta only off mode to the meta only on mode of step **1125** of FIG. **11** according to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention.

FIG. **14** is directed to the case in which the used memory space is greater than the first threshold ($N\%$). In this case, the control unit **200** controls to display the selected meta information with the meta only on mode indicator icons as shown in the screen denoted by reference number **621** of FIG. **6** at step **1411**. This means that the terminal has switched from the meta only off mode to the meta only on mode and thus some meta information displayed on the display unit **240** may have and the other may not have the corresponding real data stored in the terminal. In this case, the control unit **200** controls such that the meta information having no real data are displayed with the meta only on mode indication icon as shown on the screen denoted by reference number **621** of FIG. **6**. The control unit **200** displays and processes the downloaded real data without storing the processed data at step **1413**. If a certain change occurs in the processed real data, the control unit **200** detects the change and uploads the changed real data to the server **120** at step **1415**. In the meta only on mode, the control unit **200** displays the meta information at step **1421** and downloads and processes the real data corresponding to the meta information. At this time, the meta information displayed at step **1421** have the meta only on mode indicator icon (indicating that the terminal has no real data corresponding to the meta information) as shown on the screen denoted by reference number **717** of FIG. **7**. Thereafter, the control unit **200** detects (e.g., polls for input) whether meta information is selected at step **1423**. If meta information is determined to be selected, the process proceeds to step **1421**. Otherwise, if meta information is determined to have not been selected, the process returns to step **1421**.

In the meta only on mode, the user is capable of changing the real data stored in the cloud region of the memory **210**. The change may include deleting the save data or adding

15

new data and, if a certain change occurs, the control unit **200** detects this at step **1415** and uploads the changed real data to the server **120** while saving the changed data in the memory **210** at step **1417**. In the case in which the real data is deleted or shrunk in size, the used memory space is reduced and, if this operation is repeated, the used memory space of the memory **210** may become less than a second threshold value (M %). The control unit **200** detects that the used memory space becomes less than the second threshold value (M %) at step **1419** and returns the procedure to step **1115** of FIG. **11**. In this case, the control unit **200** is capable of downloading the real data corresponding to the meta information processed in the meta only on mode; and, once the real data are downloaded to be stored in the memory **210**, the control unit **200** displays the meta information without the meta only on mode indicator icon as shown on the screen denoted by reference number **719** of FIG. **7**.

As described with reference to FIGS. **11** to **14**, the terminal operating in the meta only off mode synchronizes the meta information and real data with the copies saved in the server **120** at the initial synchronization step and then switches between the meta only off mode and the meta only on mode according to the used memory space of the memory **210**.

In the meta only off mode, the terminal downloads the meta information from the server to acquire synchronization of the meta information between the terminal and the server and downloads the real data corresponding to the meta information in sequence at the initial synchronization step. At this step, the terminal as a client is capable of acquiring synchronization of the meta information and the real data with the copies saved in the server. If a piece of meta information is selected in the state in which the initial synchronization has been acquired, the terminal checks the memory **210**. At this time, if the used memory space is not greater than the first threshold (N %), the terminal downloads the real data corresponding to the selected meta information and stores the downloaded data in the memory **210**. Otherwise, if the used memory space is greater than the first threshold, the terminal displays an alarm message (e.g. popup message) and stops storing the downloaded real data (i.e. switches the operation mode to the meta only on mode). If the used memory space decreases to reach the second threshold (M %) while operating in the meta only off mode, the terminal switches the meta only on mode to the meta only off mode again.

According to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the first and second threshold values are used for analyzing the used memory space of the memory **210** (i.e., the memory region set for storing the cloud data in the meta only off mode). As an example, the first threshold (N %) is used as a criterion for switching from the meta only off mode to the meta only on mode, and the second threshold (M %) is used as a criterion for switching from the meta only on mode to the meta only off mode, the first threshold being greater than the second threshold. However, it is possible to use only one threshold value. In this case, the terminal can be configured to operate, if the used memory space is greater than the threshold value, in the meta only on mode and, otherwise, in the meta only off mode.

According to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the terminal operating in the meta only on mode or meta only off mode is capable of modifying the real data saved in the server **110**. For example, the terminal can be configured to have the capability of only playing/displaying the real data or the capability of deleting or modifying the real data (e.g., adding new data to the real data or deleting

16

a part of the real data). In this case, it is necessary to acquire synchronization of the meta information and real data between the terminal and the server. In the case that the real data is modified in the terminal, it may be necessary to update the corresponding copy of the modified real data in the server or not. In the former case, if the real data is modified (or deleted) in the terminal, the terminal uploads the meta information and/or the real data of the modified (deleted) data to the server to synchronize the meta information and/or the real data with the copies saved in the server. In the latter, however, if it is intended to modify the real data only in the terminal (i.e., the real data corresponding to the currently selected meta information is intended to be modified locally, e.g., the user may change the resolution of an exif picture without upload), the terminal is capable of deleting the real data modified after it has been consumed (displayed/processed).

As described above, the data sharing method of exemplary embodiments of the present invention characterized in that the terminal switches its operation mode between the meta data only on mode and the meta data only off mode in processing the real data with the meta information such that the cloud service can be provided in the operation mode as intended by the user. The meta data only on mode is advantageous for providing the cloud service to the low end and/or low capacity terminals. According to an exemplary embodiment of the present invention, the terminal operating in the meta data only on mode loads, when a piece of meta information of the real data of the selected data type is selected, the real data on to the cache region temporarily and formats the cached region after completing the use of the real data to secure the space for processing other data. In the case of the terminal having no space enough for the device cache region, it is possible to use an external memory card for securing the execution space. As describe above, the cloud service method of exemplary embodiments of the present invention is capable of managing the contents using the meta information on behalf of the real data of the contents, resulting in minimization of the gap with the cloud service (single view is supported—data saved in the cloud server data and terminal are identical with each other).

While the invention has been shown and described with reference to certain exemplary embodiments thereof, it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as defined by the appended claims and their equivalents.

What is claimed is:

1. A portable communication device comprising:

memory storing one or more programs;
a transceiver to support a wireless communication;
a display; and
one or more processors,

wherein the one or more programs include instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors individually or collectively, cause the portable communication device to:

store, in the memory, a content and an image representative of the content,

transmit, via the transceiver, the content to a server,

display, via the display, the image representative of the content,

based at least on that the content is not stored in the memory, transmit, via the transceiver, a request to the server to transmit the content to the portable communication device, while displaying the image representative of the content,

17

receive, via the transceiver, a content related to the request from the server,
 after the content related to the request is received from the server, display, via the display, the received content,
 based on a modification of the received content being completed, store, in the memory, the modified content and an image representative of the modified content, and transmit, via the transceiver, the modified content to the server, and
 after the modified content is transmitted to the server, remove the modified content from the memory if an amount of a remaining available space of the memory is less than a specified amount,
 wherein the modified content is retained in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is not less than the specified amount.

2. The portable communication device of claim 1, wherein the image representative of the content has lower resolution with respect to the content, and wherein the image representative of the modified content has lower resolution with respect to the modified content.

3. The portable communication device of claim 1, further comprising:

a camera,

wherein the one or more programs further include instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors individually or collectively, cause the portable communication device to:
 capture the content using the camera.

4. The portable communication device of claim 1, wherein the one or more programs further include instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors individually or collectively, cause the portable communication device to:

remove the content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount, wherein the content is retained in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is not less than the specified amount.

5. The portable communication device of claim 1, wherein the one or more programs further include instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors individually or collectively, cause the portable communication device to:

display, via the display, an indicator on the displayed image representative of the content, based at least on that the content is not stored in the memory.

6. The portable communication device of claim 1, wherein image representative of the modified content is retained in the memory in case the modified content is removed from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount.

7. The portable communication device of claim 1, wherein the one or more programs further include instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors individually or collectively, cause the portable communication device to:

perform the removing of the modified content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount, and the retaining of the modified content in the memory if the

18

amount of the remaining available space of the memory is greater than the specified amount, based on a user selectable setting.

8. The portable communication device of claim 7, wherein the one or more programs further include instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors individually or collectively, cause the portable communication device to:

receive a first user input for selecting a setting menu,
 in response to receiving the first user input, display, via the display, the setting menu including a menu item,
 receive a second user input for setting the user selectable setting of the menu item, and

in response to receiving the second user input, set the user selectable setting of the menu item, and display, via the display, the setting menu including the menu item with a visual indication indicating the set user selectable setting of the menu item.

9. The portable communication device of claim 1, wherein the one or more programs further include instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors individually or collectively, cause the portable communication device to:

perform the removing of the modified content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount, and the retaining of the modified content in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is greater than the specified amount, automatically without further user input.

10. The portable communication device of claim 1, wherein a cloud service is provided to the portable communication device by the server.

11. A method performed by a portable communication device, the method comprising:

storing, in a memory of the portable communication device, a content and an image representative of the content;

transmitting, via a transceiver of the portable communication device, the content to a server;

displaying, via a display of the portable communication device, the image representative of the content;

based at least on that the content is not stored in the memory, transmitting, via the transceiver, a request to the server to transmit the content to the portable communication device, while displaying the image representative of the content;

receiving, via the transceiver, a content related to the request from the server;

after the content related to the request is received from the server, displaying, via the display, the received content;

based on a modification of the received content being completed, storing, in the memory, the modified content and an image representative of the modified content, and transmitting, via the transceiver, the modified content to the server; and

after the modified content is transmitted to the server, removing the modified content from the memory if an amount of a remaining available space of the memory is less than a specified amount, wherein the modified content is retained in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is not less than the specified amount.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the image representative of the content has lower resolution with respect to the content, and

19

wherein the image representative of the modified content has lower resolution with respect to the modified content.

13. The method of claim 11, further comprising: capturing the content using a camera of the portable communication device. 5

14. The method of claim 11, further comprising: removing the content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount, wherein the content is retained in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is not less than the specified amount. 10

15. The method of claim 14, further comprising: displaying, via the display, an indicator on the displayed image representative of the content, based at least on that the content is not stored in the memory. 15

16. The method of claim 11, wherein the image representative of the modified content is retained in the memory in case the modified content is removed from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount. 20

17. The method of claim 11, wherein, the removing of the modified content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount, and the retaining of the modified content in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is greater than the specified amount, are performed based on a user selectable setting. 25 30

18. The method of claim 17, further comprising: receiving a first user input for selecting a setting menu; in response to receiving the first user input, displaying, via the display, the setting menu including a menu item; receiving a second user input for setting the user selectable setting of the menu item; and 35 in response to receiving the second user input, setting the user selectable setting of the menu item, and displaying, via the display, the setting menu including the menu item with a visual indication indicating the set user selectable setting of the menu item. 40

19. The method of claim 11, wherein, the removing of the modified content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount, and the retaining of the modified content in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is greater than the specified amount, are performed automatically without further user input. 45

20. The method of claim 11, wherein a cloud service is provided to the portable communication device by the server. 50

21. A portable communication device comprising: memory storing one or more programs; a transceiver to support a wireless communication; a display; 55 a camera; and one or more processors,

wherein the one or more programs include instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors individually or collectively, cause the portable communication device to: 60

store, in the memory, a content and an image representative of the content, transmit, via the transceiver, the content to a server, display, via the display, the image representative of the content, 65

20

retain the content in the memory if an amount of a remaining available space of the memory is greater than a specified amount,

remove the content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount,

based at least on that the content is not stored in the memory, transmit, via the transceiver, a request to the server to transmit the content to the portable communication device, while displaying the image representative of the content,

receive, via the transceiver, a content related to the request from the server,

after the content related to the request is received from the server, display, via the display, the received content,

based on a modification of the received content being completed, store, in the memory, the modified content and an image representative of the modified content, and transmit, via the transceiver, the modified content to the server, and

after the modified content is transmitted to the server, remove the modified content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount, wherein the modified content is retained in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is not less than the specified amount.

22. A method performed by a portable communication device, the method comprising:

storing, in a memory of the portable communication device, a content and an image representative of the content;

transmitting, via a transceiver of the portable communication device, the content to a server;

retaining the content in the memory if an amount of a remaining available space of the memory is greater than a specified amount;

removing the content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount;

displaying, via a display of the portable communication device, the image representative of the content;

based at least on that the content is not stored in the memory, transmitting, via the transceiver, a request to the server to transmit the content to the portable communication device, while displaying the image representative of the content;

receiving, via the transceiver, a content related to the request from the server;

after the content related to the request is received from the server, displaying, via the display, the received content;

based on a modification of the received content being completed, storing, in the memory, the modified content and an image representative of the modified content, and transmitting, via the transceiver, the modified content to the server; and

after the modified content is transmitted to the server, removing the modified content from the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is less than the specified amount, wherein the modified content is retained in the memory if the amount of the remaining available space of the memory is not less than the specified amount.

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